Advanced Viva Insights — Collaboration Analysis Guide

Using the Advanced Analysis Workbench for Workplace Collaboration Patterns Beyond Copilot

Contents

1. Purpose

This guide covers using Viva Insights Advanced Analysis to understand workplace collaboration patterns **beyond Copilot**. The same analyst workbench, the same org data, the same privacy settings, and the same Power BI workflow — but with different metrics and templates focused on meetings, focus time, wellbeing, and manager effectiveness.

Collaboration analysis provides the organisational context that makes Copilot impact data meaningful. Without understanding baseline collaboration patterns, it is impossible to measure whether Copilot is genuinely improving how people work.

2. Relationship to Copilot Analytics

Collaboration analysis and Copilot analytics share the same infrastructure. Understanding their relationship helps analysts maximise both capabilities.

Aspect	Copilot Analytics	Collaboration Analysis
Role required	Insights Analyst	Insights Analyst (same role)
Org data	Shared org data upload	Same org data — carries over automatically
Privacy settings	Shared privacy configuration	Same privacy settings apply
Partitions	Configured per agency/BU	Same partitions carry over
Metrics focus	Copilot adoption, usage, impact, sentiment	Collaboration time, meeting patterns, focus t
Data retention	Up to 13 months	Up to 27 months
Power BI workflow	Download .pbit → paste IDs → Load	Same workflow
Can run simultaneously	Yes — no conflict. Both query types can be active concurrently.	

> **Key Insight:** If you have already configured org data, partitions, and privacy settings for Copilot Analytics, you can start running collaboration queries immediately with no additional setup.

3. Available Collaboration Templates

Viva Insights provides pre-built Power BI templates for common collaboration analysis scenarios. Each template includes predefined metrics, visualisations, and narrative guidance.

Template	Analysis Focus
Ways of Working	Collaboration patterns, meeting effectiveness, wellbeing, coaching
Meeting Effectiveness	Meeting culture — duration, frequency, overlap, multitasking
Wellbeing – Balance & Flexibility	Focus time, work-life balance, urgency, flexible schedules, breaks, community
Impact Explorer	Impact estimation of Viva Insights actions
Manager Effectiveness	Manager 1:1 time, team collaboration, span of control
External Collaboration	Collaboration with external contacts — meetings, email, chat

Template References

- Ways of Working

- Meeting Effectiveness
- Wellbeing – Balance & Flexibility
- Impact Explorer
- Manager Effectiveness
- External Collaboration

4. Key Behavioural Metrics

The following table groups the core behavioural metrics available for collaboration analysis. These metrics can be used in templates, custom queries, and filters.

Category	Metrics
Meeting Hours	Meeting hours, recurring meeting hours, conflicting meeting hours, multitasking meeting hou
Focus Time	Focus hours, uninterrupted focus hours, booked focus hours (via Viva Insights focus plan)
After-Hours	After-hours collaboration hours, after-hours meeting hours, after-hours email hours, after-hc
Email	Email hours, emails sent, emails read
Chat & Calls	Chat hours, chats sent, call hours, calls made
Manager Interaction	Manager 1:1 meeting hours, manager co-attendance hours
Collaboration Scope	Internal collaboration hours, external collaboration hours, cross-group collaboration hours, n

> **Metric Tip:** "Multitasking meeting hours" captures time in meetings where the employee was also actively sending emails or chats — a strong indicator of meeting overload or low meeting relevance.

Reference: Viva Insights Metric Definitions

5. Custom Query Capabilities

Beyond the pre-built templates, analysts can create fully custom queries with tailored metrics, filters, and groupings.

Custom Metric Features

- Filter metrics by day of week (e.g., meeting hours on Fridays only)
- Filter by meeting duration (e.g., meetings longer than 60 minutes)

- Filter by attendee count (e.g., meetings with more than 10 attendees)
- Filter by organisational attributes from org data (e.g., department, location, level)
- Clone existing metrics and modify filters for tailored analysis

Copilot Assistant

The Viva Insights analyst workbench includes a Copilot assistant that can help you choose appropriate metrics and filters based on your analysis goals. Describe what you want to measure, and the assistant will suggest relevant metrics and configurations.

> **Power User Tip:** Clone a standard metric (e.g., "Meeting hours"), then add a filter for "recurring = true" and "duration > 60 minutes" to create a metric that specifically captures time in long recurring meetings — a common target for optimisation.

Reference: Custom Metrics in Viva Insights

6. Prerequisites

The prerequisites for collaboration analysis are the same as for Copilot Analytics. If you have already set up the Copilot Analytics environment, no additional configuration is required.

Requirement	Details
Role	Insights Analyst role assigned in the Microsoft 365 Admin Center
Licences	50+ Viva Insights licences for Advanced Analytics (included with Microsoft 365 Copilot licen
Power BI Desktop	December 2022 release or later
Org Data	Uploaded via Viva Insights admin settings (CSV or Azure AD sync)
Behavioural Insights	Enabled via VFAM: `TenantPolicyForBehavioralExperiences = ON`. This is a tenant-level s

> **Note:** If `TenantPolicyForBehavioralExperiences` is set to OFF, no behavioural metrics (meeting hours, focus time, etc.) will be available — for either Copilot or collaboration queries. This is the single most common blocker for new deployments.

7. How to Create a Collaboration Report

The workflow for creating a collaboration report follows the same pattern as Copilot Analytics templates. If you have created a Copilot query before, this process will be familiar.

1. Sign in to analysis.insights.viva.office.com with your Insights Analyst account.
2. Select **Create analysis** from the left navigation, then choose **Templates**.
3. Select a collaboration template — for example, **Ways of Working**.
4. Configure the query:
    - 5 **Name:** Give it a descriptive name (e.g., "Q1 2026 Ways of Working – All Agencies")
    - 6 **Time period:** Select the analysis window — collaboration data supports up to 27 months
    - 7 **Auto-refresh:** Enable if you want the query to re-run automatically on a schedule
8. Review the predefined metrics included in the template. Optionally add custom metrics using the **Add metric** button.
9. Set employee filters to scope the analysis (e.g., specific departments, locations, or levels). Select which org attributes to include in the output for grouping.
10. Select **Run** to execute the query. Processing time depends on population size and time period — typically 30 minutes to several hours.
11. Once complete, download the **.pbit** file (Power BI template) from the query results page.
12. Open the .pbit file in Power BI Desktop. When prompted, paste the **Partition ID** and **Query ID** from the Viva Insights results page. Select **Load**.
13. Explore the report — navigate through the pre-built pages, apply filters, and customise visualisations as needed.
14. To share with leadership, use the **Publish Reports** feature in Viva Insights to push a read-only version to authorised viewers.

> **Time-Saver:** If you have an existing Copilot query with org attributes and filters configured, you can use the same setup for your collaboration query — just select a different template. No need to reconfigure org data or privacy settings.

8. Common Use Cases

Scenario 1: Meeting Culture Audit

Template: Meeting Effectiveness

Goal: Identify meeting overload, long recurring meetings, and multitasking patterns across the organisation.

Approach:

1. Run the Meeting Effectiveness template with a 6-month time window.
2. Analyse metrics: recurring meeting hours, meetings > 60 minutes, multitasking hours.
3. Group by department or business unit to identify hotspots.
4. Calculate potential time savings: if average employee spends 4 hours/week in meetings that could be emails, that's X hours reclaimed per person per week.

Outcome: Data-driven recommendations to reclaim meeting time, backed by actual behavioural data rather than surveys.

Scenario 2: Wellbeing Baseline Before Copilot Rollout

Template: Wellbeing – Balance & Flexibility

Goal: Capture focus time, after-hours work, and work-life balance metrics **before** Copilot deployment. Then compare after 3 months using the Copilot Impact template.

Approach:

1. Run the Wellbeing template covering the 4 weeks immediately before Copilot licence assignment — this is the "4-week baseline window" referenced in the Copilot Analytics Implementation Guide.
2. Record baseline metrics: average focus hours, after-hours collaboration hours, weekend work hours.
3. After 3 months of Copilot usage, run the Copilot Impact template for the same population.
4. Compare pre- and post-deployment metrics to quantify Copilot's impact on employee wellbeing.

Outcome: Quantifiable evidence of whether Copilot improved, maintained, or negatively affected employee wellbeing metrics.

Scenario 3: Manager Effectiveness Programme

Template: Manager Effectiveness

Goal: Identify managers with low 1:1 time or high span of control. Feed insights into leadership development initiatives.

Approach:

1. Run the Manager Effectiveness template for the past 6 months.
2. Analyse metrics: manager 1:1 meeting hours, team size (span of control), team after-hours patterns.
3. Filter to managers with fewer than 30 minutes of 1:1 time per direct report per month.
4. Cross-reference with team wellbeing metrics to identify teams with both low manager engagement and high after-hours work.

Outcome: Targeted list of managers who would benefit from coaching programmes, with behavioural evidence to support the recommendation.

9. Data Retention

Understanding data retention windows is important for planning analysis timeframes and comparing historical trends.

Data Type	Maximum Retention	Notes
Collaboration metrics (meetings, email, chat, focus time)	Up to 27 months	Starts at 13 months and grows w
Copilot metrics (adoption, usage, impact, sentiment)	Up to 13 months	Shorter retention window due to

> **Practical Implication:** Collaboration analysis can look further back in history than Copilot analysis. This means you can establish a rich historical baseline of collaboration patterns — even if Copilot was deployed recently. Use the longer retention window to identify seasonal trends, reorganisation impacts, and long-term cultural shifts.

10. References

Topic	URL
Ways of Working Template	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/ways-of-v
Meeting Effectiveness Template	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/meeting-e
Wellbeing – Balance & Flexibility Template	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/wellbeing
Impact Explorer Template	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/impact-ex
Manager Effectiveness Template	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/manager-
External Collaboration	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/external-collaboratic
Metric Definitions	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/reference/metrics
Custom Metrics	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/custom-metrics

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